

Chapter 109-2

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Xu Qingzhu did end up reading poetry to Liang Shi. She recited it very properly, her emotions changing along with the content of the poems.

But every line that fell into Liang Shi's ears carried a lingering, tender meaning.

On a bed where they had just done certain things.

It really was hard not to let one's mind wander.

Even if it was just simply reading poetry.

There were many poems—some describing scenery, some expressing emotions—but for Liang Shi, what mattered wasn't the content of the poems, but the voice reading them.

She listened to Xu Qingzhu read poetry with her eyes half-closed, drowsiness gradually washing over her.

Under the dim yellow light, Xu Qingzhu's figure became increasingly hazy, as if seen through a layer of thick fog, impossibly beautiful.

When Xu Qingzhu saw that her breathing had become steady, she stopped reading, set down the poetry collection in her hands, placed the book on the nightstand, and dimmed the bedside lamp to its lowest setting. Then she lay down in the same position as Liang Shi.

Her arm was pressed under her head, propping it up slightly, while Liang Shi was tilted downward. Xu Qingzhu's other hand hovered in front of her eyes as she called out softly: "Jiejie."¹

This call of "Jiejie" was tender and gentle.

Her cool voice carried a unique texture. Her fingertips landed below Liang Shi's eyelids, lightly brushing across.

This movement made the sleeping Liang Shi stir slightly. Xu Qingzhu quickly withdrew her hand. Liang Shi, finding the position uncomfortable, shifted to lie flat on her back.

After a moment, she turned onto her side again. Her arm moved slightly, her fingers curled a little, and her mouth mumbled a single word.

Xu Qingzhu had good hearing and immediately made it out.

She had said: "Hug~"

Because she was asleep, the trailing sound was especially soft.

Xu Qingzhu lifted her blanket and obediently nestled into her embrace.

Liang Shi's hand naturally came to rest on her waist, as if by instinct. The moment it landed, her fingers lightly pinched her waist.

But because she was asleep, there was no strength behind it, so it turned into a gentle caress.

Yet her body's characteristics still made Xu Qingzhu let out an involuntary hum.

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Xu Qingzhu was so annoyed she wanted to bite her. But when her teeth touched Liang Shi's chin, she softened the pressure.

She merely rubbed against her skin like a cat, making Liang Shi feel ticklish. Liang Shi's palm came to rest on the top of her head, gently soothing her.

Xu Qingzhu immediately quieted down, her head pressed against Liang Shi's heart, slowly nuzzling against it like an obedient cat.

That place was as soft as Liang Shi's heart.

Xu Qingzhu lay contentedly against her heart.

To her, this was Jiejie.

The Jiejie she was willing to give everything for.

They had once run hand in hand without destination, had once watched fireflies dance under a pitch-black sky, had once embraced for warmth in a place with no light.

But her Jiejie had forgotten her.

It's okay, as long as she's by my side, Xu Qingzhu thought.

Those weren't good memories anyway, so forget them.

Xu Qingzhu closed her eyes and pressed close to her heart, listening to her steady heartbeat.

Xu Qingzhu held her tight and whispered: "Jiejie, it's enough that I remember you."

Everything you've forgotten, I will remember for you.

Those painful, unbearable, sorrowful memories of the past—don't ever recall them again.

I can accept you forgetting even me.

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1. "姐姐" (Jiejie) means "older sister" in Chinese. This is a term of endearment and respect. The context suggests Xu Qingzhu and Liang Shi (or rather, the original owner of Liang Shi's body) share a past that Liang Shi has forgotten, and Xu Qingzhu still calls her "Jiejie" from that time. ←